

126

Andrew

The brother who kept bringing people to Jesus.

Andrew was a fisherman from Bethsaida and the brother of Simon Peter. He first followed John the Baptist, and he was one of the first two men to follow Jesus. His first act as a disciple was to find his brother and say, "We have found the Messiah." That pattern marks nearly every scene where John's Gospel names him. He brings Peter to Jesus. He brings a boy with five loaves to Jesus. He brings a question from some Greeks to Jesus. Andrew never preaches a sermon in Scripture, and he often stands in his famous brother's shadow. Yet his quiet habit of introducing others to Christ has made him a model for ordinary believers.

At a glance

<i>Name</i>	Greek <i>Andreas</i> , "manly"
<i>Family</i>	Brother of Simon Peter; son of Jonas (John 1:40–42)
<i>Home</i>	Bethsaida; later shared a house with Peter in Capernaum (John 1:44; Mark 1:29)
<i>Work</i>	Fisherman on the Sea of Galilee (Mark 1:16)
<i>First teacher</i>	A disciple of John the Baptist (John 1:35–40)
<i>Main passages</i>	John 1:35–42; 6:5–13; 12:20–22; Mark 1:16–18; 13:3
<i>Later life</i>	Not recorded in Scripture; see Tradition on page 4

"He first findeth his own brother Simon, and saith unto him, We have found the Messiah, which is, being interpreted, the Christ."

John 1:41, KJV

The life of Andrew

Dates are approximate (AD). Jesus' ministry is dated c. AD 27/28–30 in this study.
Scripture does not give Andrew's age.

- c. AD 27–28

Beyond Jordan

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Follows Jesus

Andrew hears John the Baptist call Jesus "the Lamb of God." He and another disciple follow Jesus and spend the rest of the day with him. *John 1:35–40*
- c. AD 27–28

Beyond Jordan

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Brings his brother

He finds Simon and tells him they have found the Messiah. Then he brings Simon to Jesus, who names him Cephas. *John 1:41–42*
- c. AD 28

Sea of Galilee

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Called to fish for men

Jesus sees Simon and Andrew casting a net into the sea and calls them to follow him. They leave their nets at once. *Mark 1:16–18*
- c. AD 29

Near the Sea of Galilee

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Finds the loaves

Before Jesus feeds the five thousand, Andrew points out a boy with five barley loaves and two small fishes, though he wonders what good they are. *John 6:5–13*
- c. AD 30

Jerusalem

●

Brings the Greeks

At the last Passover some Greeks ask Philip to see Jesus. Philip tells Andrew, and together they tell Jesus. *John 12:20–22*

Group notes

Key activities

Andrew is named only about a dozen times in the New Testament, most often in John's Gospel. The other disciple with him in John 1:35–40 is not named; many think it was John the apostle.

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- 1 **Followed the Lamb of God.** When his teacher pointed to Jesus, Andrew followed and asked where he was staying. *John 1:37–39*
 - 2 **Brought his brother.** He went first to Simon with the news that the Messiah had come. *John 1:40–42*
 - 3 **Left his nets.** He answered Jesus' call to become a fisher of men. *Mark 1:16–18; Matthew 4:18–20*
 - 4 **Was chosen as an apostle.** He is named among the Twelve in every list. *Matthew 10:2; Mark 3:18; Luke 6:14; Acts 1:13*
 - 5 **Asked about the future.** With Peter, James and John he asked Jesus privately on the Mount of Olives when the temple would fall. *Mark 13:3–4*
 - 6 **Offered what little there was.** He brought a boy's lunch to Jesus, asking, "But what are they among so many?" *John 6:8–9*
 - 7 **Opened the way for Greeks.** He helped carry the request of some Greek visitors to Jesus. *John 12:20–22*
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Group notes

Across Scripture

Direct references first. Echoes are study links, not places that name Andrew.

Old Testament

Echo: 2 Samuel 7:12-16	The anointed king Andrew hoped for as "the Messias"
Echo: 2 Kings 4:42-44	Elisha feeds a hundred with twenty barley loaves

New Testament

John 1:35-42	Andrew follows Jesus and brings Simon
Mark 1:16-18, 29; Matthew 4:18-20	Called with Peter; Jesus visits their home
Mark 13:3	With the inner three on the Mount of Olives
John 6:8-9; 12:22	He brings the loaves and the Greeks
Acts 1:13	In the upper room; his last mention in Scripture
Tradition	Preached by the Black Sea and Greece, crucified at Patras; the X-shaped cross is much later

For discussion

- Observe:* Who did Andrew bring to Jesus in John 1, John 6 and John 12?
- Understand:* Andrew wondered what five loaves could do "among so many." What does Jesus' answer teach about small offerings?
- Apply:* Andrew started with his own brother. Who in your family or circle could you invite to "come and see"?
- Apply:* What small gift, skill or hour could you hand to Jesus this week, even if it seems too little?